

SAFE VS. UNSAFE SYMPTOMS IN PREGNANCY

Why This Information Matters

Pregnancy involves a wide range of physical changes. While most symptoms are normal, some require immediate medical evaluation. Being informed helps pregnant individuals and their support people respond appropriately.

Generally Safe and Expected

- Mild nausea and food aversions in the first trimester
- Fatigue and increased need for sleep
- Frequent urination throughout pregnancy
- Mild breast tenderness and fullness
- Mild swelling of ankles and feet late in pregnancy
- Mild heartburn and indigestion
- Occasional light-headedness when standing
- Braxton Hicks contractions after week 20
- Increased vaginal discharge without odor or irritation
- Mild back pain with positional relief

Seek Urgent Care Immediately For:

- Heavy vaginal bleeding (more than a light spotting)
- Severe or sudden abdominal or pelvic pain
- Sudden severe headache not relieved by rest
- Blurred vision, seeing spots, or sudden vision changes
- Sudden swelling of the face, hands, or eyes
- Chest pain or difficulty breathing
- Decreased or no fetal movement after week 24
- Signs of preterm labor: regular contractions, pelvic pressure, or water breaking before week 37
- High fever (above 100.4°F / 38°C)
- Burning or pain with urination, especially with fever

Key Takeaway

Understanding which symptoms are normal and which require immediate attention empowers pregnant individuals to seek help promptly. If anything feels wrong, contact a healthcare provider without delay.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (n.d.). Warning signs during pregnancy. March of Dimes. (2020).

Warning signs and symptoms during pregnancy. National Health Service. (2023). Signs and symptoms of pregnancy problems.